MEDLINE via Ovid

PI(CO)S	#	Search
Population	#1	exp Varicocele/
	#2	exp Infertility, Male/
	#3	((male* or men) adj7 (infertil* or subfertil*)).tw.
	#4	(Varicocele* or Varicocoele*).tw.
	#5	(varicocele or varicocoele or varicoceles or spermatic vein varicosity or varicose spermatic veins or pampinocele or spermophlebectasia or cirsocele or varicole or ramex).tw.
	#6	or/1-5
Intervention	#7	exp Acupuncture/
	#8	exp Acupuncture Therapy/ or exp Electroacupuncture/ or acupuncture needle.mp.
	#9	exp Acupressure/
	#10	acupoint.mp. or exp Acupuncture Points/
	#11	needle pricking.mp.
	#12	warming needle moxibustion.mp.
	#13	(acupunctur* or acupressur*).tw.
	#14	(electrostimulat* or electroacupunctur*).tw.
	#15	(acupoint* or acupotom*).tw.
	#16	(auriculotherap* or auriculoacupunct*).tw.
	#17	(needl* or needl* prick*).tw.
	#18	body needl*.tw.
	#19	dry needl*.tw.
	#20	warm* needle moxibustion.mp. or warm* acupuncture.tw. [mp=title, abstract, original title, name of substance word, subject heading word, floating sub-heading word, keyword heading word, organism supplementary concept word, protocol supplementary concept word, rare disease supplementary concept word, unique identifier, synonyms]
	#21	meridian*.tw.
	#22	qi.tw.
	#23	or/7-22
Study design	#24	randomized controlled trial.pt.
	#25	controlled clinical trial.pt.
	#26	randomized.ab.
	#27	placebo.ab.
	#28	drug therapy.fs.
	#29	clinical trials as topic.sh.
	#39	randomly.ab.
	#31	trial.ti.
	#32	24 or 25 or 26 or 27 or 28 or 29 or 30 or 31
	#33	exp animals/ not humans.sh.

	#34	32 not 33
	#35	6 and 23 and 34

EMBASE

PI(CO)S	#	Search
Population	#1	'varicocele'/exp
	#2	'male infertility'/exp
	#3	varicocele*:ab,ti OR varicocoele*:ab,ti
	#4	('male* infertil*'):ab,ti OR (('men infertil*'):ab,ti) OR (('male* subfertil*'):ab,ti) OR (('men subfertil*'):ab,ti)
	#5	(Varicocele):ab,ti OR ((varicocoele):ab,ti) OR ((varicoceles):ab,ti) OR (('spermatic vein varicosity'):ab,ti) OR ((varicose):ab,ti) OR (('spermatic vein*'):ab,ti) OR ((pampinocele):ab,ti) OR ((spermophlebectasia):ab,ti) OR ((cirsocele):ab,ti) OR ((varicole):ab,ti) OR ((ramex):ab,ti)
	#6	#1 OR # OR #2 OR #3 OR #4 OR #5
Intervention	#7	'acupuncture'/exp
	#8	'acupuncture needle'/exp
	#9	'acupressure'/exp
	#10	'acupoint'/exp
	#11	'needle pricking'/exp
	#12	'warming needle moxibustion'/exp
	#13	acupunctur*:ab,ti OR acupressur*:ab,ti
	#14	(electro* NEAR/1 (stimulat* OR acupunctur*)):ab,ti
	#15	electrostimulat*:ab,ti OR electroacupunctur*:ab,ti
	#16	acupoint*:ab,ti OR acupotom*:ab,ti
	#17	auriculotherap*:ab,ti OR auriculoacupunct*:ab,ti
	#18	needl*:ab,ti
	#19	('needl* prick*'):ab,ti
	#20	(body NEXT/1 needl*):ab,ti
	#21	(dry NEXT/1 needl*):ab,ti
	#22	('warm* needle moxibustion'):ab,ti OR ('warm* acupuncture'):ab,ti
	#23	meridian*:ab,ti
	#24	qi:ab,ti
	#25	#7 OR #8 OR #9 OR #10 OR #11 OR #12 OR #13 OR #14 OR #15 OR #16 OR #17 OR #18 OR #19 OR #20 OR #21 OR #22 OR #23 OR #24
Study design	#26	'randomized controlled trial'/de
	#27	'controlled clinical trial'/de
	#28	random*:ti,ab,tt
	#29	randomization'/de

	#30	'intermethod comparison'/de
	#31	placebo:ti,ab,tt
	#32	(compare:ti,tt OR compared:ti,tt OR comparison:ti,tt)
	#33	((evaluated:ab OR evaluate:ab OR evaluating:ab OR assessed:ab OR assess:ab) AND (compare:ab OR compared:ab OR comparing:ab OR comparison:ab))
	#34	(open NEXT/1 label):ti,ab,tt
	#35	((double OR single OR doubly OR singly) NEXT/1 (blind OR blinded OR blindly)):ti,ab,tt
	#36	'double blind procedure'/de
	#37	(parallel NEXT/1 group*):ti,ab,tt
	#38	(crossover:ti,ab,tt OR 'cross over':ti,ab,tt)
	#39	((assign* OR match OR matched OR allocation) NEAR/6 (alternate OR group OR groups OR intervention OR interventions OR patient OR patients OR subject OR subjects OR participant OR participants)):ti,ab,tt
	#40	(assigned:ti,ab,tt OR allocated:ti,ab,tt)
	#41	(controlled NEAR/8 (study OR design OR trial)):ti,ab,tt
	#42	(volunteer:ti,ab,tt OR volunteers:ti,ab,tt)
	#43	'human experiment'/de
	#44	trial:ti,tt
	#45	#26 OR #27 OR #28 OR #29 OR #30 OR #31 OR #32 OR #33 OR #34 OR #35 OR #36 OR #37 OR #38 OR #39 OR #40 OR #41 OR #42 OR #43 OR #44
	#46	(((random* NEXT/1 sampl* NEAR/8 ('cross section*' OR questionnaire* OR survey OR surveys OR database or databases)):ti,ab,tt) NOT ('comparative study'/de OR 'controlled study'/de OR 'randomised controlled':ti,ab,tt OR 'randomized controlled':ti,ab,tt OR 'randomly assigned':ti,ab,tt))
	#47	('cross - sectional study'/de NOT ('randomized controlled trial'/de OR 'controlled clinical study'/de OR 'controlled study'/de OR 'randomised controlled':ti,ab,tt OR randomized controlled':ti,ab,tt OR 'control group':ti,ab,tt OR 'control groups':ti,ab,tt))
	#48	('case control*':ti,ab,tt AND random*:ti,ab,tt NOT ('randomised controlled':ti,ab,tt OR 'randomized controlled':ti,ab,tt))
	#49	('systematic review':ti,tt NOT (trial:ti,tt OR study:ti,tt))
	#50	(nonrandom*:ti,ab,tt NOT random*:ti,ab,tt)
	#51	'random field*':ti,ab,tt
	#52	('random cluster' NEAR/4 sampl*):ti,ab,tt
	#53	(review:ab AND review:it) NOT trial:ti,tt

	#54	('we searched':ab AND (review:ti,tt OR review:it))
	#55	'update review':ab
	#56	(databases NEAR/5 searched):ab
	#57	((rat:ti,tt OR rats:ti,tt OR mouse:ti,tt OR mice:ti,tt OR swine:ti,tt OR porcine:ti,tt OR murine:ti,tt OR sheep:ti,tt OR lambs:ti,tt OR pigs:ti,tt OR piglets:ti,tt OR rabbit:ti,tt OR rabbits:ti,tt OR cat:ti,tt OR cats:ti,tt OR dog:ti,tt OR dogs:ti,tt OR cattle:ti,tt OR bovine:ti,tt OR monkey:ti,tt OR monkeys:ti,tt OR trout:ti,tt OR marmoset*:ti,tt) AND 'animal experiment'/de)
	#58	('animal experiment'/de NOT ('human experiment'/de OR 'human'/de))
	#59	34 #46 OR #47 OR #48 OR #49 OR #50 OR #51 OR #52 OR #53 OR #54 OR #55 OR #56 OR #57 OR #58
	#60	#45 NOT #59
	#61	#6 AND #25 AND #60

Central Register of Controlled Trials (CENTRAL) via Cochrane Library

PI(CO)S	#	Search
Population	#1	MeSH descriptor: [varicocele] explode all trees
	#2	MeSH descriptor: [Infertility, Male] explode all trees
	#3	(varicocele*):ti,ab,kw OR (varicocoele*):ti,ab,kw
	#4	(male* infertil*):ti,ab,kw OR (men infertil*):ti,ab,kw OR (men subfertil*):ti,ab,kw OR (male* subfertil):ti,ab,kw
	#5	(varicocele):ti,ab,kw OR (varicocoele):ti,ab,kw OR (varicoceles):ti,ab,kw OR (spermatic vein varicosity):ti,ab,kw OR (varicose spermatic veins):ti,ab,kw
	#6	(pampinocele):ti,ab,kw OR (spermophlebectasia):ti,ab,kw OR (cirsocele):ti,ab,kw OR (varicole):ti,ab,kw OR (ramex):ti,ab,kw
	#7	#1 OR # OR #2 OR #3 OR #4 OR #5 OR #6
Intervention	#8	MeSH descriptor: [Acupuncture] explode all trees
	#9	MeSH descriptor: [Acupressure] explode all trees
	#10	MeSH descriptor: [Acupuncture Points] explode all trees
	#11	(acupressur*):ti,ab,kw OR (acupunctur*):ti,ab,kw
	#12	(electro* NEAR/1 stimulat*):ti,ab,kw OR (electro* NEAR/1 acupunctur*):ti,ab,kw
	#13	(electrostimulat*):ti,ab,kw OR (electroacupunctur*):ti,ab,kw
	#14	(acupoint*):ti,ab,kw OR (acupotom*):ti,ab,kw
	#15	(auriculotherap*):ti,ab,kw OR (auriculoacupunct*):ti,ab,kw
	#16	(needl*):ti,ab,kw
	#17	(needl* prick*):ti,ab,kw
	#18	(body NEXT/1 needl*):ti,ab,kw

	#19	(dry NEXT/1 needl*):ti,ab,kw
	#20	(warm* needle moxibustion):ti,ab,kw OR (warm* acupuncture):ti,ab,kw
	#21	(meridian*):ti,ab,kw
	#22	(qi):ti,ab,kw
	#23	#8 OR #9 OR #10 OR #11 OR #12 OR #13 OR #14 OR #15 OR #16 OR #17 OR #18 OR #19 OR #20 OR #21 OR #22
Study design	#24	MeSH descriptor: [randomized controlled trial] explode all trees
	#25	MeSH descriptor: [controlled clinical trial] explode all trees
	#26	MeSH descriptor: [clinical trial] explode all trees
	#27	random*:ti,ab,kw
	#28	placebo:ti,ab,kw
	#29	trial:ti,ab,kw
	#30	#24 OR #25 OR #26 OR #27 OR #28 OR #29
	#31	MeSH descriptor: [animal] explode all trees
	#32	#30 NOT #31
	#33	#7 AND #23 AND #32

China National Knowledge Infrastructure(CNKI)

(TKA='针灸' OR TKA='针刺' OR TKA='温针' OR TKA='电针' OR TKA='针挑') AND (TKA='精索静脉曲张') AND TKA='随机'

Filter by: synonym expansion

China Science and Technology Journal Database (VIP Database)

(M=针灸 OR 针刺 OR 温针 OR 电针 OR 针挑) AND (M=精索静脉曲张) AND (R=随机)

Chinese Biomedical Literature Database (SinoMed)

("随机"[常用字段:智能]) AND ("精索静脉曲张"[常用字段:智能]) AND ("针灸"[常用字段:智能] OR "针刺"[常用字段:智能] OR "温针"[常用字段:智能] OR "电针"[常用字段:智能] OR "针挑"[常用字段:智能])

Wanfang Data

(((摘要=随机)) AND (题名或关键词=精索静脉曲张)) AND ((((((题名或关键词=针刺) OR 题名或关键词=针灸) OR 题名或关键词=温针) OR 题名或关键词=电针) OR 题名或关键词=针挑))

International Clinical Trials Registry Platform (ICTRP)

Condition: varicocele* OR varicocoele OR spermatic vein varicosity OR varicose spermatic vein* OR varicole

Intervention: acupuncture OR acupoint OR needl* prick* OR electroacupunctur* OR warm* needl* moxibustion

ClinicalTrials.gov

Condition or disease: "varicocele" OR "varicocoele" OR "spermatic vein varicosity" OR "varicose spermatic veins" OR "varicole"

Other terms: "acupuncture" OR "acupoint OR "needle pricking" OR "electroacupuncture" OR "warming needle moxibustion"

Chinese Clinical Registry (CHICTR)

Target disease: varicocele

PROSPERO

Search bar: varicocele